

The choice of the appropriate chart type depends upon how you want the data to be represented. If you can't figure out what chart type best represents your data, try out all the charts on offer in Excel 2007.



The types of charts in Excel 2007

6.2.1 The Column chart

A Column chart is the most popular type, and the emphasis is on data that shows time variation.

To view the gallery of Column charts, go to **Insert > Column**, and the gallery will drop down. There are five sub-types of charts, namely 2-D column, 3-D column, Cylinder, Cone, and Pyramid.

A data series can be represented with differently-coloured columns. Also, data series can be stacked upon corresponding data points for relative representation of two or more data series. This could be used to compare sales of two product substitutes in a specific period.



The types of Column charts

6.2.2 The Line chart

For continuous plotting of data series and viewing trends, Line charts are very popular and widely used. Usually, equal intervals are displayed over the category axis, where more emphasis lies on trends portraying relative importance to values. Under this are seven sub-types, divided into 2D and 3D.